

SEVERITY

SEV-1: broad customer impact, revenue path affected, or data integrity risk.

SEV-2: material degradation with workaround or limited blast radius.

SEV-3: minor degradation with low customer impact.

Two independent critical signals on a TIER_1 service are sufficient to open an incident.

Never infer customer impact from CPU alone; corroborate with errors, latency, queueing, or support evidence.

CONTAINMENT AND CHANGE SAFETY

If degradation begins within 15 minutes of a deployment, evaluate rollback as a candidate action.

Rollback requires evidence that the changed service is plausibly causal.

Database failover is a HIGH_RISK action and always requires human Incident Commander approval.

Do not restart a database solely because an application service has high latency.

Prefer reversible actions before destructive or state-changing actions.

ESCALATION

SEV-1 always requires Incident Commander escalation.

Any action touching a TIER_1 database requires platform on-call approval.

Contradictory evidence must be surfaced; do not hide it to make a recommendation look stronger.

If evidence confidence is below MEDIUM, gather more evidence before customer communication unless safety requires.

COMMUNICATION

Customer-facing status is required for confirmed SEV-1 and SEV-2 incidents with external impact.

State observed symptoms and mitigation; do not state an unverified root cause as fact.

Strategic customers receive a direct account update after public status is approved.

Internal updates must distinguish FACT, HYPOTHESIS, ACTION, and OPEN QUESTION.

RECOVERY AND CLOSURE

Recovery requires two consecutive healthy observation windows for the primary SLO.

After mitigation, continue monitoring dependent services for at least 15 minutes.

Capture timeline, evidence, decisions, rejected hypotheses, and human approvals for post-incident review.